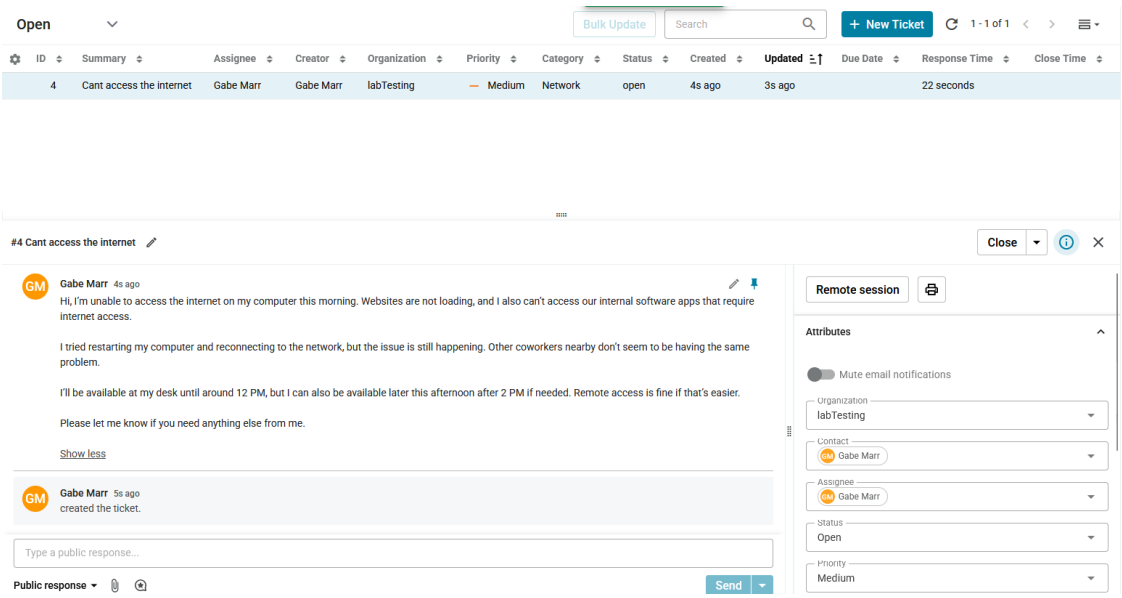
Simulating IT Tickets through Spiceworks

Breaking the Network – DNS issue

I will complete a basic helpdesk-style network connectivity scenario focused on troubleshooting a computer that cannot access websites or internal software apps. The scenario involves identifying a DNS config issue, testing connectivity with command-line tools, correcting the DNS settings, flushing the DNS cache, verifying internet access was restored, documenting internal notes and closing the ticket after use confirmation.

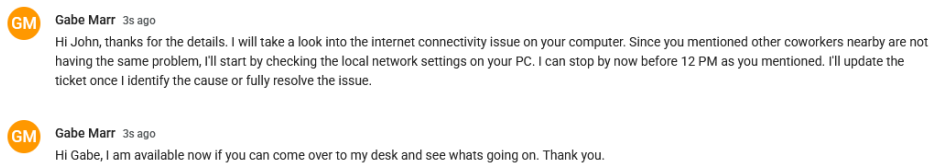
To create the problem, I will set a preferred DNS of 204.0.113.1 so the Internet stops working (websites won't be able to load).

Creating the ticket in SpiceWorks now...

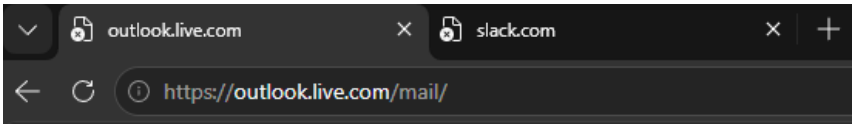


The priority level will be set to medium because the impact is "Individual user impacted".

Conversation:



Currently at the employee's computer physically resolving the issue. I can see that John cannot access slack or outlook via the web (domain name not resolving):



Troubleshooting begins:

1. Open cmd and check if John has an IP address first – John does

```
C:\Users\[redacted]>ipconfig

Windows IP Configuration


Ethernet adapter Ethernet:

   Connection-specific DNS Suffix  . :
   IPv4 Address. . . . . . . . . . . : 192.168.1.93
   Subnet Mask . . . . . . . . . . . : 255.255.255.0
   Default Gateway . . . . . . . . . : 192.168.1.1
```

2. Ping a DNS server via its IP address (8.8.8.8) – that works

```
C:\Users\[redacted]>ping 8.8.8.8

Pinging 8.8.8.8 with 32 bytes of data:
Reply from 8.8.8.8: bytes=32 time=14ms TTL=116
Reply from 8.8.8.8: bytes=32 time=14ms TTL=116
Reply from 8.8.8.8: bytes=32 time=17ms TTL=116
Reply from 8.8.8.8: bytes=32 time=10ms TTL=116

Ping statistics for 8.8.8.8:
    Packets: Sent = 4, Received = 4, Lost = 0 (0% loss),
Approximate round trip times in milli-seconds:
    Minimum = 10ms, Maximum = 17ms, Average = 13ms
```

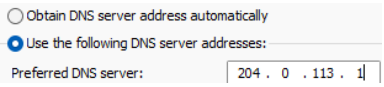
3. Ping the domain name google.com to see if it's a DNS problem – Confirmed DNS issue

```
C:\Users\[redacted]>ping google.com
Ping request could not find host google.com. Please check the name and try again.
```

Fixing the issue

1. I will check the network adapter settings specifically ethernet (IPv4 settings)

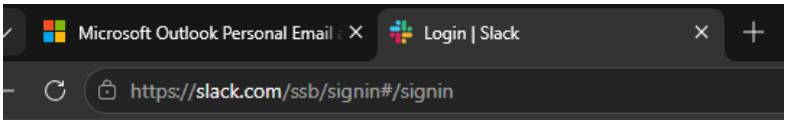
Network & Internet -> Advanced network settings -> Ethernet -> More adapter options -> IPv4:



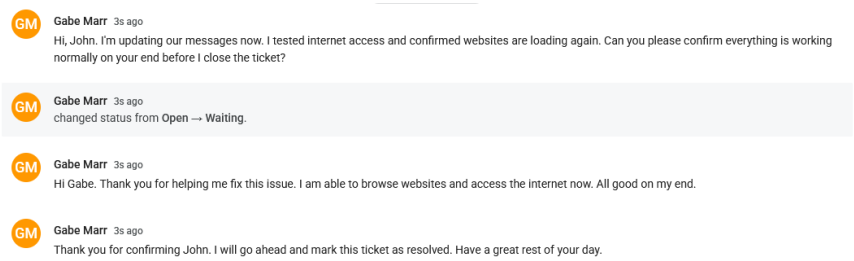
John had a static preferred DNS server set. I will change it to "Obtain server address automatically" and flush the dns. Re-testing the ping on google.com should work now:

```
C:\Users\[redacted]>ping google.com

Pinging google.com [142.251.211.206] with 32 bytes of data:
Reply from 142.251.211.206: bytes=32 time=8ms TTL=116
Reply from 142.251.211.206: bytes=32 time=16ms TTL=116
Reply from 142.251.211.206: bytes=32 time=10ms TTL=116
Reply from 142.251.211.206: bytes=32 time=17ms TTL=116

Ping statistics for 142.251.211.206:
    Packets: Sent = 4, Received = 4, Lost = 0 (0% loss),
Approximate round trip times in milli-seconds:
    Minimum = 8ms, Maximum = 17ms, Average = 12ms
```

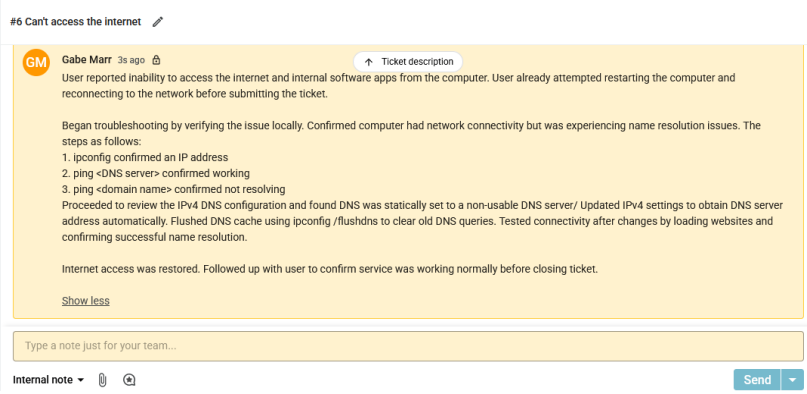
Testing connectivity after changes by loading websites and confirming successful name resolution:



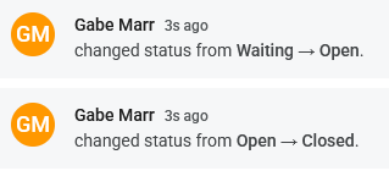
I went back to my desk and provided an updated message to John on the ticket waiting for final approval on his end that the issue isn't persisting and he can successfully browse to websites (setting the ticket status to Waiting):



I will be adding the "Internal note" part for my team for future reference if similar issues arise:



Closing the ticket now...

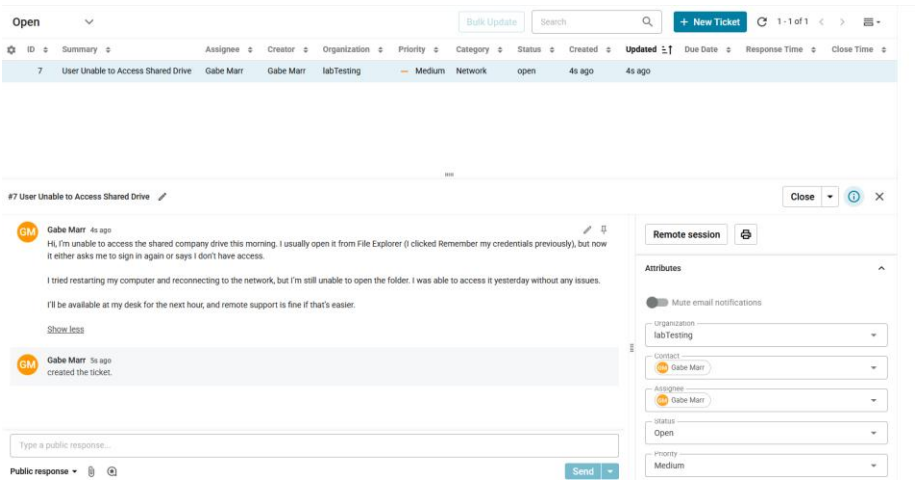


Shared Drive Access Fails Due to Cached Credentials

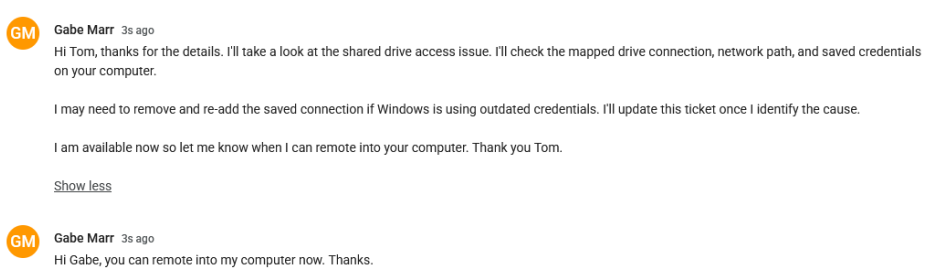
I will also complete an additional scenario designed to be more realistic and closer to a Tier 1/Tier 2 helpdesk issue. This scenario focuses on troubleshooting shared network drive access after a user password change, including network share connectivity, permissions, outdated cached credentials, and Windows Credential Manager.

The issue: The user recently changed their password during a required password rotation, but their workstation still had the old password saved for the network share. When they tried opening the shared drive, Windows either attempted the old, saved credential automatically or prompted them again. The user kept entering the old password out of habit, not realizing the share now required the updated password.

The ticket:



Conversation:



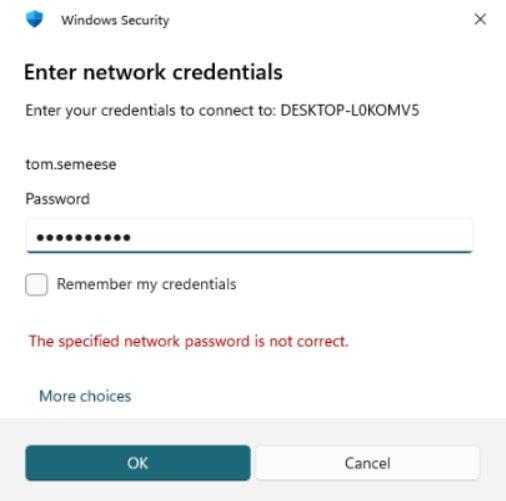
Troubleshooting the issue via AnyDesk:

1. I will be confirming network connectivity first by pinging the “file server” to see if its reachable – Its reachable

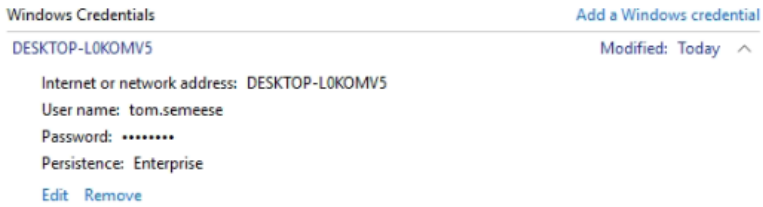
```
C:\Users\[redacted]>ping DESKTOP-L0KOMV5

Pinging DESKTOP-L0KOMV5.local [fe80::4730:71ce:92f2:bacc%12] with 32 bytes of data:
Reply from fe80::4730:71ce:92f2:bacc%12: time<1ms
Reply from fe80::4730:71ce:92f2:bacc%12: time<1ms
Reply from fe80::4730:71ce:92f2:bacc%12: time<1ms
Reply from fe80::4730:71ce:92f2:bacc%12: time<1ms

Ping statistics for fe80::4730:71ce:92f2:bacc%12:
    Packets: Sent = 4, Received = 4, Lost = 0 (0% loss),
Approximate round trip times in milli-seconds:
    Minimum = 0ms, Maximum = 0ms, Average = 0ms
```

2. Next, I will test the share path once again

No access denied. But Tom is being prompted to enter a password even though he saved his old credential by checking “Rember my credentials”. Tom most likely has been trying his old password and forgot that he must use the updated password that he set when the password rotation took place within the company a couple days ago.



The old password that was stored in the creds manager is most likely the old password and not the new one that Tom updated a couple days ago:



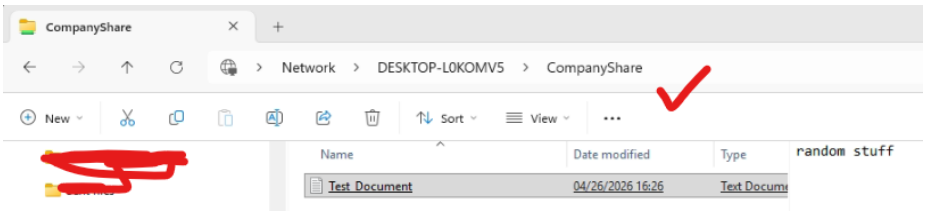
I will ask him now if he was attempting to share connection with the old password still and tried the updated password he set a couple days ago:

Gabe Marr 3s ago
Hi Tom, I see that its prompting you to enter a password again even though you most likely saved the credential previously. A couple days ago, all departments had to update their passwords. Did you try the new password you set when authenticating?

Gabe Marr 3s ago
Ah yea, I recently changed my password. I didn't think of it when trying to access the shared drive here. I have been entering the old since its what I last remember. I believe I remember the new one I set. Let me try that now and Ill get back to you if it works. Thanks.

Gabe Marr 3s ago
Sounds good Tom. Remember to hit the "Remember my credentials" button so the Windows cred manager can save the new password again.

Tom attempted authentication with the new password and was able to access the CompanyShare:



More conversations confirming success:

Gabe Marr 3s ago
Hi Tom. Great. Since you clicked "Remember my credentials" on the successful attempt the Windows credential manager will automatically update the old entry with the new password. You can access the CompanyShare automatically again without re-entering credentials until the next password change rotation of course. Just to double check, everything okay now before I close the ticket?

Gabe Marr 6s ago
changed status from **Open** → **Waiting**.

Gabe Marr 3s ago
Hi Gabe. Everything is good on my end. Thanks for the help.

Internal note:

Gabe Marr 3s ago Ticket description
User reported being unable to access the shared company drive after a recent password change. User stated the drive was previously accessible but began prompting for credentials and rejecting the usual password.

Verified computer had network connectivity to the shared drive host and confirmed the shared folder path was reachable. Issue appeared to be related to authentication rather than general network connectivity or share availability.

Checked Windows Credential Manager and confirmed a saved Windows credential existed for the shared drive host. Reconnected to the shared folder using the user's current password and selected "Remember my credentials" to update the saved credential.

Verified the shared folder opened successfully and files were accessible. User confirmed access was restored before ticked closure.

Show less

Resolved:

Gabe Marr 3s ago
changed status from **Waiting** → **Open**.

Gabe Marr 3s ago
Resolved "User Unable to Access Shared Drive". Have a great day Tom.